

THE SOLAR SYSTEM

Introduction

The **Solar System** is made up of the **Sun and all the objects that move around it**. These objects include planets, moons, asteroids, comets, and meteoroids. The Sun is at the center of the Solar System.

The Solar System formed about **4.6 billion years ago**.

THE SUN

The **Sun** is a star and the **largest object in the Solar System**. It gives **light and heat**, which makes life possible on Earth.

Importance of the Sun

- Provides **light**
- Provides **heat**
- Helps plants grow through **photosynthesis**
- Controls the **climate and weather**

The Sun is made mostly of **hydrogen and helium gas**.

THE PLANETS

There are **8 planets** in the Solar System. They all orbit around the Sun.

The 8 Planets (in order from the Sun)

1. **Mercury**
 - Closest planet to the Sun
 - Very hot during the day and very cold at night
2. **Venus**
 - Hottest planet
 - Covered with thick clouds
3. **Earth**
 - The only planet known to support life
 - Has water, air, and land

4. **Mars**
 - Known as the **Red Planet**
 - Has the largest volcano in the Solar System
 5. **Jupiter**
 - The **largest planet**
 - Has a big storm called the **Great Red Spot**
 6. **Saturn**
 - Famous for its **rings** made of ice and rock
 7. **Uranus**
 - Rotates on its **side**
 - Has a blue-green color because of methane gas
 8. **Neptune**
 - The **farthest planet** from the Sun
 - Known for very strong winds
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OTHER OBJECTS IN THE SOLAR SYSTEM

Moons

Moons are **natural satellites** that orbit planets.
Example: Earth has **one moon**.

Asteroids

Asteroids are **rocky objects** that orbit the Sun. Most of them are found in the **Asteroid Belt** between Mars and Jupiter.

Comets

Comets are made of **ice, dust, and rock**. When they get close to the Sun, they form a **bright tail**.

Meteoroids

Meteoroids are **small rocks in space**. When they enter Earth's atmosphere, they are called **meteors** or “shooting stars”.